

Richard Bekhazi

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PROFILE

Engineering Leader and Systems Architect with 8+ years of experience building scalable, data-driven platforms and production-grade systems in highly regulated enterprise environments. Adept at designing robust APIs, horizontal data pipelines, and reusable analytics components that empower cross-functional application teams. Proven track record of bridging the gap between foundational infrastructure and domain experts, consistently translating complex business models into reliable, high-performance software architectures. Leverages a Master's in Engineering Management to lead technical strategy, drive cross-team alignment, and mentor engineering talent through complex system deployments and modernization cycles.

EXPERIENCE

📅 11/2021 – 01/2026

TECHNICAL LEAD & AI SYSTEMS ARCHITECT BANK OF CANADA

- **Local Enterprise AI Architecture:** Architected and deployed a secure, locally hosted generative AI platform leveraging Ollama to serve open-source models (Meta LLaMA, Qwen). Successfully engineered a cost-optimized, CPU-based inference environment to navigate strict enterprise security and budget constraints without relying on external APIs or GPUs.
- **Full-Stack Application Delivery:** Developed interactive, front-end data applications using Python (Streamlit), enabling economists to query complex macroeconomic indicators, DSGE model outputs, and Impulse Response Functions (IRFs) directly through a natural language interface.
- **Data Engineering & Integration:** Designed robust data pipelines and complex system integrations across a diverse stack (MATLAB IRIS Toolbox, SQL Server, Python), establishing the foundational data layer required for advanced time-series modeling and AI-assisted analytics.
- **Cross-Functional Technical Leadership:** Acted as the primary technical bridge between domain experts (economists) and core engineering, successfully translating complex, multi-objective economic models into production-ready software solutions.
- **Engineering Management & Team Development:** Led agile engineering cycles, driving sprint planning, rigorous testing, and technical knowledge transfer sessions to

EXPERIENCE

mentor team members and elevate overall engineering standards.

- **System Modernization & Reliability:** Maintained scalable, well-documented codebases and drove the modernization of legacy enterprise platforms through performance optimization, ensuring long-term maintainability and auditability.

📅 03/2019 – 08/2021

GLOBAL TECHNICAL PROJECT LEAD UNILOG

- **Global Engineering Leadership:** Directed cross-functional technical teams across South Africa and the MENA (Middle East and North Africa) regions, successfully driving the delivery of complex, data-driven enterprise solutions in diverse international markets.
- **End-to-End Platform Architecture (Sage X3):** Spearheaded the comprehensive planning, custom development, and full-scale delivery of Sage X3 enterprise platforms. Designed horizontal APIs and robust data pipelines to unify financial, sales, and operational workflows across global deployments.
- **Cross-Cultural Stakeholder Alignment:** Acted as the crucial bridge between core engineering and international stakeholders. Leveraged native fluency in English, Arabic, and French to seamlessly translate complex regional business models into scalable, production-ready technical implementations.
- **System Optimization & Automation:** Engineered generalized automation utilities and leveraged AI-assisted analytics to streamline system diagnostics, performance tuning, and issue resolution, significantly increasing deployment efficiency and reliability at scale.
- **Team Enablement & Deployment:** Managed hands-on system deployments and fostered a culture of continuous learning by leading extensive technical onboarding and system training programs for regional engineering and client teams.

📅 07/2017 – 02/2019

DATA SYSTEMS ENGINEER BANK EL MAWARID

- **Data Pipelines & Integrity:** Engineered and maintained automated data processing and audit workflows, establishing robust data integrity monitoring and traceability crucial for downstream operational controls.

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- Cross-Functional Reporting Foundations: Designed reporting abstractions and data-driven systems that unified requirements across Operations, Compliance, and Management, ensuring the reliable delivery of actionable insights.
- Production System Optimization: Managed the implementation of critical, management-driven system updates in highly regulated production environments, continuously optimizing internal banking processes through targeted software enhancements.

📅 09/2013 – 07/2016

TECHNICAL INTEGRATION LEAD
SUPPLY NETWORK SOLUTION (SNS)

- International Platform Delivery: Led the implementation and architectural customization of enterprise ERP and WMS platforms across complex, multi-national deployments in KSA, UAE, Qatar, and Lebanon.
- API Design & Integration Patterns: Designed and deployed robust API integrations and Java-based system customizations, building reusable patterns to connect core platforms with third-party enterprise services.
- Analytics Components: Developed foundational reporting and analytics components utilizing Eclipse and Infor toolsets, providing broad data visibility to client stakeholders.
- Technical Mentorship & Resolution: Fostered technical adoption by delivering hands-on onboarding and technical training for client engineering teams, while acting as the primary escalation point for diagnosing complex integration failures and system performance bottlenecks.

EDUCATION

📅 06/2018

MASTERS IN ENGINEERING MANAGEMENT
American University of Beirut

📅 06/2012

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING IN COMPUTER
AND COMMUNICATION (CCE)
American University of Beirut

📅 06/2007

LEBANESE AND FRENCH BACCALAUREATE IN
GENERAL SCIENCE
College Saint Joseph Antoura

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGIES

📌 TECHNOLOGIES

Python
Julia

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGIES

📌 TECHNOLOGIES

MATLAB
Java
SQL
DAX

📌 DATA & INTEGRATIONS

Complex ETL / Data Pipelines
RESTful APIs
JSON-based services
Relational Databases

📌 TOOLING

Git
CI/CD pipelines
Environment Automation

📌 LANGUAGES

English Native
French Native
Arabic Native

AI & MACHINE LEARNING INFRASTRUCTURE

- Local LLM Deployment & Inference: Ollama, CPU-based Inference Optimization
- Open-Source Models: Meta LLaMA (3.2), Qwen (2.5)
- Domain-Specific AI: Prompt engineering and context alignment for complex data (Macroeconomic forecasting, Timeseries modeling)
- System Benchmarking & Hardware Optimization (CPU, Memory, Disk I/O)

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE & ENGINEERING

- Application Frameworks: Python (Streamlit) for rapid data application development
- Macroeconomic Tooling: MATLAB (IRIS Toolbox), Time Series Modeling
- Horizontal Platform Design & Scalability
- API Design & Reusable Integration Patterns

TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP & DELIVERY

- Cross-Functional Team Leadership & Mentorship
- Global Project Management & Cross-Cultural Alignment
- Agile/Scrum Engineering Cycles
- Technical Strategy & Stakeholder Roadmapping